INCH-POUND
A-A-58004A
10 AUGUST 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-58004
18 FEBRUARY 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TRUCK, FIRE FIGHTING, WATER TANKER, 5000 GALLON CAPACITY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all federal agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This Commercial Item Description (CID) describes a commercial Water Tanker (WAter TAnker - WATA) Truck: diesel engine, automatic transmission, six by four chassis, with a two person cab, a 5000 gallon water tank, an agent pumping system, and equipment compartments. The WATA truck is intended to: store water, transport over hard and gravel surface roads, self-fill, pump, and transfer water in support of brush, structural, and aircraft fires.

2. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

2.1 The WATA truck shall be an assembly of new materials and shall be free of defects in design and construction that affect appearance, serviceability and durability. The WATA truck shall conform to the more stringent of State or Federal Laws, applicable to a vehicle of this class and type, for use on the public roads and highways. All components of the WATA truck shall be represented in the manufacturer's sales literature as standard or optional equipment. The WATA truck shall meet all the requirements found in Chapters 1, 2, 5, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 15, 19, and 21, of National Fire Protection Association publication, NFPA 1901, Standard for Pumper Fire Apparatus, 1996 Edition, as applicable to a vehicle of the configuration specified. The WATA truck shall meet the performance parameters listed or referenced and shall be equipped as specified. Failure of the WATA truck to meet the annotated salient characteristics shall be cause for rejection of the vehicle.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any other data which may improve this document should be sent to: WR-ALC/TILBA, 420 SECOND STREET, SUITE 100, ROBINS AFB GA 31098-5609.

AMSC N/A FSC 4210

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.1 General and Apparatus Requirements. In addition to the minimum requirements of NFPA 1901, the WATA truck shall include:

a. The capabilities to self-fill, store, transport, and distribute 5000 gallons of water. The water quality will range from clear, through brackish, to sea water. The system design and the selection of materials for the tank, pump, piping, and associated parts should not be dependent on a capability to flush the systems with clean or clear water.

b. When specified, an operational design elevation for the engine(s) and the agent pumping system at 8000 feet above sea level.

c. The capability to operate in temperatures ranging from 0 to +125 degrees F.

d. When specified, a winterization system that extends the operational range of the truck, the agent pump and the agent piping systems to -40 degrees F. While in non-response status, the winterization system shall be powered through an electrical cable connected to a 120 volt, AC, 15 amp, building receptacle. While in operational status, the appropriate systems requiring winterization shall be truck powered.

e. All hose connections in accordance with National Standard Fire Hose Threads.

f. Mounts for, and also provide two 10 foot long, light weight six inch hard suction hoses, with six inch long handle female couplers on one end and six inch long handle male couplers on the other. Mount for, and also a suction strainer.

g. A cross-lay hose tray, between the back of the truck cab and the front of the water tank, for a 200 foot, preconnected, 1 ¾ inch double jacketed fire hose.

h. Compartment space for six, 50 foot lengths, rolled five inch fire hose.

i. Compartment space for, and also provide a 15 foot long, six inch soft suction hose, with a 4 1/5 inch long handle female coupler on one end and a six inch long handle female coupler on the opposite end.

j. Compartment space for, and also provide a 5000 gallon minimum capacity, portable water storage pond. The pond wall height shall not exceed the height of the bottom of the water tank dump valve, while the truck and pond are on a common level surface.

k. Compartment space for, but not including, the fire hose and nozzle requirements listed in 5-7.1 of NFPA 1901.

l. Compartment space for and also the full complement of Equipment listed in 5-7.2 of NFPA 1901, less the self-contained breathing apparatus (SCBA) and the spare SCBA cylinders. Two individual compartments, or a two bottle rack in a compartment, shall be included for purchaser provided one hour capacity SCBA air bottles.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.2 Chassis and Vehicle components.

a. The WATA truck shall have a net payload (passengers and equipment) capacity of 5,000 pounds plus 5000 gallons of water.

b. The WATA truck shall have a driver controlled emergency engine shutdown.

c. The WATA truck engine shall be equipped with a manufacturer approved replaceable element, dry type air filter.

d. The WATA truck shall have dual, parallel-piped fuel filters.

e. The WATA truck shall have an electric fuel priming pump.

f. The WATA truck brake system shall be fully air operated.

g. When specified, an engine or transmission retarder shall be provided.

h. When specified, a magnetic driveline retarder shall be provided.

i. The WATA truck shall be equipped with tubeless, steel, radial tires mounted on steel disc wheels. Tire and wheel assemblies shall be interchangeable at all positions. Tread design shall be of the non-directional on/off-highway type. An identical spare wheel and tire assembly shall be provided.

j. The WATA truck shall be equipped with fender liners, having tire chain clearance, over the rear axles.

k. The WATA truck shall be equipped with traction control or locking differentials.

l. The WATA truck shall have a minimum 50 gallon fuel tank.

m. The WATA truck shall have a lighted license plate bracket at the left rear.

2.1.3 Low voltage electrical systems and warning devices.

a. The WATA truck shall have a 12 volt electrical and starting system.

b. The WATA truck shall have an on-board battery charger, providing a minimum 15 amp output. The charger shall be powered from a labeled, covered, recessed, male, 120 volt, AC receptacle, located near the driver’s door or at the left side front corner of the truck body. A charge meter shall be installed next to the receptacle. A minimum 50 foot long, three wire, 15 amp rated, 120 volt AC, power cable shall be provided.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

c. The WATA truck shall utilize a single alternator charging system that exceeds, by 10%, the minimum continuous electrical load as defined by 9-3.2 of NFPA 1901.

d. The WATA truck battery system shall be the chassis manufacturer's largest available option, in terms of Cold Cranking Amperage.

e. The WATA truck shall have non-glare white lighting at ladders and access steps where personnel work or climb during night operations. Ladder, step, and area lights shall be controlled with switches on the cab instrument panel and near the light source.

f. The WATA truck cab and compartments shall be provided with white lighting. Lights shall automatically illuminate when the respective doors are opened. Cab interior light levels shall be high enough for reading maps or manuals. The cab shall have a separately switched red interior light.

g. All WATA truck warning lights, except for white lights, shall use strobe type elements.

h. The WATA truck shall have, at a minimum, a six red element light bar, with both forward and side facing heads, mounted to the cab roof. The light bar shall be separately switched from the warning light panel.

i. The WATA truck shall have a high beam, alternating/flashing, headlight system. The headlight flasher shall be separately switched from the warning light panel.

j. When specified, all red warning and strobe lights shall be replaced with blue.

k. The WATA truck shall be equipped with an electronic siren system. The amplifier unit shall include volume control and selection of "Radio", "PA", "Manual", "Yelp", "Wail", and "Hi-Lo" (European) modes, and a magnetic noise canceling microphone. The amplifier, microphone and controls shall be within reach of the driver and right front passenger. Siren activating foot switches shall be located in front of the driver and the right front passenger. The siren speaker shall be located in a guarded position.

l. The WATA shall be equipped with an air horn. Air horn activating foot switches shall be located in front of the driver and the right front passenger. The air horn shall be located in a guarded position.

m. The WATA shall have interior switched and adjustable spotlights located, one each, at the front top corners of the cab.

n. The WATA shall have a separate 15 amp circuit, with breaker, serving the cab for a purchaser provided radio system.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.4 Driving and crew areas (Cab).

a. The WATA truck cab shall include seating for a driver and one additional crew member. The driver's seat shall be an adjustable air suspension design and the crew member seat shall be of a non-suspension design with a backrest and brackets designed to store a one hour self-contained breathing air apparatus.

b. When specified, a tilt and telescoping steering column shall be provided.

c. In addition to standard instrumentation, the following shall be provided:

1). Master warning light control switch.

2). Work light switch(es).

3). Compartment "Door Open" warning light and alarm.

d. The cab climate control system shall provide adequate heat, defrost and fresh air at ambient design conditions down to -40 degrees F. Supplemental equipment may be integrated into the basic commercial system to meet the performance requirements.

e. When specified, provide a cab air conditioning system.

f. The WATA truck shall be equipped with combination flat and convex outside rear view mirrors on each side of the truck, mounted in fold-back west coast style brackets.

g. When specified, the outside rear view mirrors shall be have heated heads.

2.1.5 Body: compartments and equipment mounting.

a. The WATA truck shall have a truck body fabricated of corrosion resistant material. The truck body may or may not enclose the water tank. The truck body shall include enough compartment space to contain all of the equipment listed in 2.1.1, e through j, above. Compartment doors shall be of weather resistant, roll-up design, with a full width bar type latch capable of a one hand release from any position along the door.

b. The WATA truck shall have a ladder and walkway to access the manhole(s) and servicing points along the top of the water tank. The ladder rungs and the walkway shall be fabricated if an open pattern, traction enhancing material, which does not allow the accumulation of water, in any operational position. Folding handrails or tie-on points shall be provided to restrain personnel from falling to the ground.

c. Compartment floors shall be accessible while standing on the ground and shall each support a 500 pound load without permanent deflection.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

d. Each compartment shall have one adjustable and removable shelf for every 18 inches of door opening.

e. Each compartment shall have a replaceable scuff plate at each door threshold attached with flush-headed cap screws and nuts, and shall not be bonded.

f. Drip rails shall be located over individual or combined compartment doors.

g. Where shelves are provided, compartments shall be illuminated both above and below the shelves.

h. Exterior surfaces of the WATA shall have a finish color of Red, Number 11136; Lime Yellow, Number 13670; or Forest Green, Number 24052, of FED-STD-595, as specified at time of purchase.

i. With Red or Lime Yellow finish colors, the cab upper body (from the bottom of windshield up) and roof shall be painted White, Number 17875 of FED-STD-595. Compartment interiors shall have a standard commercial finish. All polished metal and anodized parts, such as: mirrors, horns, light bezels, tread-plate, and roll-up compartment doors shall not be painted. A horizontal, reflective band shall be applied around the truck in an approximate plane with the headlights. Offsets in the reflective band shall be made to maximize the length of reflective surface. The reflective band may be interrupted by bright metal trim or tread-plate. The reflective band pattern shall be seven inches wide with three reflective stripes (one inch white reflective, one inch body color, three inches white reflective, one inch body color, and one inch white reflective).

j. When Forest Green finish color is specified, all surfaces, including all normally bright metal and any interior surfaces visible with any compartment door open, shall be painted Forest Green. A four inch wide horizontal, black reflective band shall be applied around the truck in an approximate plane with the headlights. Offsets in the reflective band shall be made to maximize the length of reflective surface.

k. The WATA shall have an applied corrosion treatment, to a tropical level. The first production truck shall not have the corrosion treatment applied until after the initial tests and inspections are completed.

2.1.6 Fire Pump and Associated Equipment.

a. The fire pump shall be a single stage centrifugal design, capable of pumping 1250 GPM of water at 150 psig. The pump shall be driven from the chassis propulsion engine, through a power take-off.

b. The pump priming system shall be manually controlled from the pump panel.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

c. The pump operator's control panel shall be located on the left side of the truck body near the back of the truck cab. The control panel shall have a low reflectivity surface. The pump panel shall have a master suction and a discharge pressure gauges, not less than six inches in diameter, and individual discharge outlet pressure gauges, not less than two inches in diameter. Each discharge outlet shall be controlled from the pump operator's panel through a manual valve having locking features.

d. Suction and discharge connections shall not be located on the pump operator's control panel. All side discharge connections, plus the 2 ½ inch suction connections, shall be fitted with 45 degree turn-down fittings.

e. The WATA truck shall have two each six inch suction connections, one on each side of the near the mid-point of the truck.

f. The WATA truck shall have two each 2 ½ inch suction connections, one on each side of the truck, adjacent to the six inch suction connections.

g. The WATA truck shall have two each, minimum of four inch, discharge connections, one on each side of the truck near the mid-point of the truck.

h. The WATA truck shall have two each 2 ½ inch discharge connections, one on each side of the truck near the mid-point of the truck.

i. The WATA truck shall have a 1 ½ inch discharge connection for the cross-lay hose. The hose connection shall be a swivel design allowing hose operation from either side.

2.1.7 Water Tank.

a. The WATA truck shall have a 5000 gallon minimum working capacity water tank.

b. The water tank shall have a manhole of not less than 20 inches inside diameter shall be provided for personnel access to the interior of the tank for cleaning and inspection.

c. A five light tank water level indicator shall be located on the pump operator's control panel.

d. The suction and discharge piping and valving between the pump and the water tank shall flow water at a minimum of 1250 gallons per minute.

e. A six inch gated fill connection shall be located at the right rear of the water tank.

f. A dump valve shall be installed on the rear face of the water tank for filling the portable pond provided with the truck. The dump valve shall empty 90% of the water tank volume within three minutes, with the truck on a level surface. The dump valve shall have a rigid folding chute or flexible tube extension, which does not increase the overall length of the truck while stored, to assure that all of the water in the tank is emptied into the portable pond.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.1.8 Line voltage electrical system. If the combined power requirements of the battery charger and the winterization system does not exceed 15 amps, a single electrical receptacle may be used. The battery charger shall be directly connected to the receptacle, while the winterization system shall have a labeled activation switch with a pilot light.

2.1.9 Air system. A checked, quick disconnect, air fitting shall maintain brake system pressure while the vehicle is not running and shall be located near the driver's door or at the left side front corner of the truck body.

3. **REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.**

3.1 The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent possible, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

3.1.1 Materials. For the purpose of this requirement, recovered materials are those materials that have been collected from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials, as distinguished from virgin raw materials. The components, pieces and parts incorporated in the vehicle may be newly fabricated from recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, provided the vehicle produced meets all other requirements of this CID. Used, rebuilt or re-manufactured components, pieces and parts shall not be incorporated.

4. **QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.**

4.1 Product conformance.

4.1.1 The product provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 Commercial Item Requirement:

4.2.1 The vehicle furnished must meet the "commercial item" definition, as specified in FAR 2.101, as of the date of award. The offeror/contractor shall provide two copies of their commercial, descriptive catalogs with their offer, as specified in Clause I106. The offeror/contractor shall identify all modifications made to their commercial model in order to meet the performance and descriptive requirements of the CID or the referenced documents. In regard to the offered item, the offeror/contractor shall identify any/all variations from compliance with or modifications to the performance requirements of the CID or the referenced documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Contractor requirements.

4.3.1 The contractor shall provide copies of the truck manuals for review 30 days prior to the time of tests or demonstration of the first truck. The WATA truck parts manual shall list part numbers for contractor manufactured parts, plus the part numbers for purchased sub-level components and whole components. The contractor shall provide a product familiarization videotape, that both verbally and visually provides all information for the operation and routine maintenance of the truck and its components, using the commercial manuals as a baseline, with each truck.

4.4 Testing.

4.4.1 All tests required by NFPA 1901 for the truck and its systems shall be performed by the contractor, at his facility, prior to delivery of the first truck. The contractor shall demonstrate or test, as applicable, each requirement of the CID or referenced document, prior to delivery.

4.4.2 Failure to comply with the requirements of this CID, reference documents, or the tests shall be cause for reconfiguration and re-demonstration. Causes for reconfiguration shall include: structural failure; non-correctable misalignments; component interference; conditions presenting a safety hazard to the user or maintainer, such as: instability during operation, spillage of fuel or coolant, and overheating.

4.4.3 Examination of product. A checklist of specific requirements from this CID and the referenced documents shall be compared to the final configuration of the WATA truck. Where specific certifications are required, copies shall be provided.

4.4.4 Performance test. If site conditions do not exist for the chassis performance tests, calculations will be accepted.

4.4.5 Delivery test. Each truck shall be loaded in accordance with the capacities compartment floor and shelf shall be uniformly loaded, to the individual maximum design capacity, up to a total of 5000 pounds. Each cab seat shall be loaded with 200 pounds. The fully loaded truck shall be driven over 10 miles of paved road. All loads shall be removed and all surfaces inspected for permanent deflection.

5. **PACKAGING.**

5.1 Preservation and packaging shall be the minimum necessary to afford protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2 Unless otherwise provided in the contract, the truck shall be prepared for delivery by common carrier. An identification plate, permanently marked, shall be securely mounted at the driver's compartment. The identification plate shall contain the following information:

NOMENCLATURE
MANUFACTURER'S MAKE AND MODEL
MANUFACTURER'S SERIAL NUMBER
REGISTRATION NUMBER
NATIONAL STOCK NUMBER (provided by the purchaser)
VEHICLE CURB WEIGHT: kg (pounds)
PAYLOAD, MAXIMUM: kg (pounds)
GROSS VEHICLE WEIGHT (GVW): kg (pounds)
GROSS COMBINATION WEIGHT RATING: kg (pounds)
DATE OF DELIVERY (month and year)
WARRANTY (month and km (miles))
CONTRACT NUMBER
US PROPERTY

6. **NOTES.**

6.1 Options: The purchaser shall specify the following at time of purchase:

a. If the truck shall operate at 8000 feet above sea level, (see 2.1.1,b).

b. If a winterization system is required, (see 2.1.1, d)

c. If an engine or transmission retarder is required, (see 2.1.2, g).

d. If a magnetic driveline retarder is required, (see 2.1.2, h).

e. If all red warning lights shall be replaced with blue, (see 2.1.3,j).

f. If a tilt and telescoping steering column is required, (see 2.1.4,b).

g. If a cab air conditioning system is required, (see 2.1.4,e).

h. If heated outside rear view mirrors are required, (see 2.1.4,g).

i. Finish color of vehicle (Red, Lime Yellow or Forest Green), (see 2.1.5, h).

6.2 Source of documents.

6.2.1 The Federal Standard and Federal Acquisition Regulation may be obtained from the Standardization Document Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia PA 1911-5094

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2.2 The National Fire Protection Association publications may be obtained from the NFPA, Batterymarch Park, Quincy MA 02269-9101

MILITARY INTEREST:

CUSTODIAN:
Air Force - 99

REVIEWER:
DLA - IS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
Air Force - 84

AGENT:
Air Force - 99

Project Number: 4210-0610

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.